



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ozarks Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.ozarkschristianacademy.com/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Ozarks Christian Academy (West Plains, MO, 65775) (OCA) presents a robust Classical Christian program rooted in a Christ-centered, biblical worldview. Public materials describe a Trivium-based curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric stages) with strong emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and formation of character, rather than mere information transfer. The school frames education as formation in mind, heart, and faith, integrates biblical principles across subjects, and explicitly partners with families in a discipleship-focused community. Across six evaluation domains, OCA demonstrates strong classical affinities in Religious Foundations, Purpose, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community engagement, with solid alignment in Curriculum (notably the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framework and emphasis on history) but more modest explicit signaling of Great Books/Great Conversation in published materials. The aggregate reading places OCA solidly in CLASSICAL territory, with Element 3 (Curriculum) being the most ambiguous area, leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to less explicit Great Books signaling.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Christ-centered/biblical worldview; explicit Trinitarian theology; Scriptural authority; discipleship imagery. Positive alignment with religious/metaphysical anchors is clear; few negative signals detected. **Why CLASSICAL:** Strong transcendental aims and explicit theological framing align with the Positive keywords for this domain.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Formation of mind and heart; virtue/wisdom formation; mission emphasis on Christ-centered education; formation over mere information; articulated in motto and mission statements. Positive alignment with formation-focused aims. **Why CLASSICAL:** The school explicitly prioritizes virtue, wisdom, and formation consistent with classical aims.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages; explicit Latin and classical structure; history included across curriculum; mention of classical approach and biblical integration. Negative signs: less explicit signaling of Great Books/Great Conversation in public content; the Great Books/Great Conversation signaling is not strongly evident in the visible materials. **Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL:** Core Trivium framework and historical/civic content are solid, but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signaling is not consistently demonstrated in the public site content.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Lower-grade singing/chanting/memory work; contemplative/restful aspects; upper-grade Socratic discussion/seminars/debate; rhetoric training and public speaking trajectories. **Why CLASSICAL:** Clear alignment with the anticipated pedagogy signals for classical education across stages.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Headmaster and dedicated faculty; living curriculum and mentorship language; emphasis on character and virtue in teachers; faculty-student partnership in formation. Why CLASSICAL: The public-facing materials describe teachers as mentors and core to the culture, aligning with the “living curriculum” and “model teachers” indicators.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Strong partnership with families; parent involvement emphasized; tours, communications, and formation opportunities for parents; community engagement through events and programs. Why CLASSICAL: The school explicitly frames parents as co-educators and signals ongoing parent formation and open-campus engagement.

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum) shows SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status due to less explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis. To move fully CLASSICAL, the school could foreground explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components and primary-source reading lists, or provide public articulation of a canonical Great Books program within the curriculum.
- Additional explicit signaling of liturgical or communal practices in formal documents/public pages could strengthen Element 1 signaling (Liturgical/Communal Practices) if desired, though current religious foundations are strong.

## ABSTRACT

Ozarks Christian Academy (West Plains, MO, 65775) demonstrates a strong CLASSICAL orientation across five of six evaluation categories, with Curriculum as the only category where the signal is weaker (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The school presents a Christ-centered, biblically integrated classical program, organized around the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), with explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, and character in alignment with the Six Essential Elements framework. Faith-based foundations, purpose-driven formation, a rigorous pedagogy, a mentoring faculty culture, and active parental partnership collectively position OCA as CLASSICAL. The primary area for potential needle-movement is explicit signaling of Great Books/Great Conversation within Curriculum to strengthen the overall canonical alignment.

## ABSTRACT

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL (with Curriculum as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)
- Religious Foundations: CLASSICAL — Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology emphasis
- Purpose/Goal: CLASSICAL — formation of mind and heart, virtue and wisdom
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL — Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, history, Latin; Great Books signal is limited in public content
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL — singing/memory in grammar, Socratic/seminar in higher grades, rhetoric emphasis
- Faculty: CLASSICAL — living curriculum, mentoring teachers
- Parents/Community: CLASSICAL — strong partnership with families, parent involvement, accessible campus

Now, the detailed category-by-category analysis with keyword analysis and scoring.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note: The following category evaluations apply the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements document (1). Each category includes:

- Evidence: Notable keywords/phrases present in Ozarks Christian Academy’s public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Count and contrast of positive vs. negative keywords per the Six Elements framework.
- Why this rating: Explanation tying evidence to the rubric.

## Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

## Evidence

- The public materials repeatedly frame OCA as Christ-centered and biblically directed. Statements emphasize a Christian worldview and biblical integration across disciplines. For example, mission-style language and doctrinal statements articulate a theistic, biblical foundation for education. This alignment appears in mission statements and faith-based positioning, and in explicit statements about God, the Trinity, and Scripture authority. Citations reflect the Christ-centered framing and theological commitments.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; biblical worldview; theology; Scripture; God; gospel; discipleship; Christ-focused; worship/liturgy (implicit in communal religious framing); sacred tradition (implicit in biblical grounding). The site materials frequently emphasize a biblical worldview and discipleship, aligning with the Positive keywords for this element.
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.

## Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present (approximate): 6–8 meaningful hits (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology, Scripture, gospel, discipleship, God). Negative keywords: 0.
- Estimated ratio: ~100% positive signals, 0 negative signals.
- Rating justification: The strong, explicit religious/metaphysical orientation and theological framing support CLASSICAL here.

## What would move the needle (if needed)

- If the school wished to maximize alignment with liturgical communal practices in observable public materials, it could foreground explicit liturgical activities (chapel, liturgy schedules) in its core pages. This would enhance the “Liturgical and Communal Practices” signal without changing other elements.

## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

## Evidence

- The school’s motto and mission statements foreground formation and discipleship, emphasizing the mind and heart, virtue, and wisdom. The explicit focus on formation over mere information is visible in admissions and mission statements as well as in a declared classical Christ-centered education framework. The materials discuss partnering with families and forming character through a biblical worldview. The emphasis on spiritual formation and characteristic formation aligns with classical aims.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; wisdom; virtue; human flourishing; liberal education; classical mission; pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful; sacred tradition (implicit); contemplation (in the formation frame).
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.
- Thematic positive alignment with the classical education aims suggests a strong positive signal for this category.

## Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: 4–6 meaningful terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, true/good/beautiful). Negative keywords: 0.
- Estimated ratio: Predominantly positive; no negative signals observed.
- Rating justification: The explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical mission strongly supports CLASSICAL.

## What would move the needle

- To further strengthen this category, the school could add explicit articulation of “paideia” or “great conversation” as a core outcome across grades and publish a short summary of how each subject contributes to formation of virtue and wisdom, including a brief discussion of teleology and moral imagination in routine communications.

### Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The site presents the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framework (the Trivium) and notes Latin and history as core elements, with history taught across the curriculum. The explicit statement of “Classical Christian Education” with the Trivium is visible, and there is mention of memory and recitation in the Grammar Stage as well as rhetoric training in upper grades. However, explicit signaling of Great Books and Great Conversation is not clearly evidenced in the public materials.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar stage; logic stage; rhetoric stage; Latin; history (across the curriculum); classical education; biblical integration.
- Negative keywords present: There is no explicit mention of Great Books or Great Conversation in the accessible materials; there is no explicit emphasis on project-based experiential learning as a replacement for traditional liberal arts; no strong signaling of “social studies” replacement or STEM-first framing as a curriculum driver.
- The Positive keyword set is robust (Trivium-focused structure, language arts, Latin, history) but the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation mentions yields a partial alignment.

#### Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: 5–6 core items (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Latin; history; classical education; biblical integration).
- Negative keywords present: 0–1 explicit signals (no Great Books signaling; no project-based emphasis flagged as negative in public materials).
- Ratio: Predominantly positive with a meaningful but incomplete signaling for the canonical Great Books dimension.
- Rating justification: CLASSICAL would be too strong given the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals in public content; therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL captures the current public-facing curriculum signaling.

#### What would move the needle

- Publicly emphasize Great Books/Great Conversation as a curricular pillar (e.g., listing canonical works, weekly or term-long Great Conversation themes, and Direct references to great books in course catalogs or about pages).
- Clarify a stated scope for liberal arts within the Trivium (e.g., more explicit quadrivium mentions and primary-source reading lists).

### Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The teaching methods show lower-grade memory/song/chanting and memory work; upper-grade Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. The presence of the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric progression and involvement in public speaking aligns with classical pedagogy. The content explicitly mentions Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper grades and “memory work” consistent with scholé and contemplative pedagogy in the lower grades.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion; seminars; debates; memory work; recitation; chanting; rhetoric; public speaking; scholé/contemplation; training in rhetoric.

- Negative keywords present: The public content does not emphasize project-based-only or wholly student-driven constructivist approaches; the pedagogy signals not to conflict with (and indeed align with) classical methods.
- The signals point strongly to CLASSICAL pedagogy with a clear structure aligned to the Trivium.

#### Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: 6–8 strong terms (Socratic, seminars, debates, memory work/recitation, rhetoric, public speaking).
- Negative keywords present: 0 explicit negative signals in the available public materials.
- Ratio: High positive signaling; effectively CLASSICAL.

#### What would move the needle

- To further strengthen, the school could provide explicit templates showing how each course integrates Socratic seminars and rhetoric practice across all grade bands, including example prompts, assessment rubrics, and a published schedule of rhetorical assignments.

#### Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

##### Evidence

- Materials note Headmaster and a climate of mentorship; “living curriculum” and “faculty as mentors” are described. The mission emphasizes that faculty and staff are dedicated to educating the whole child and that the faculty participate in the shaping of students’ spiritual and intellectual development. These elements align with classical faculty phenomenology.

##### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Headmaster; faculty as mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; teacher as model; collaborative teacher-student culture; moral exemplars.
- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.
- The signals indicate CLASSICAL alignment with a teacher-centered, mentoring culture central to classical education.

#### Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: 4–6 strong terms (Headmaster, living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher, collegial culture).
- Negative keywords present: 0.
- Ratio: Predominantly positive; CLASSICAL.

#### What would move the needle

- The school could publish a concise, public-facing “Teacher Profile” section that outlines the classical teacher ideal (per the Lexicon’s portrait of the teacher) including specific examples of professional development in classical pedagogy and how teachers model virtue and virtue-centered instruction.

#### Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

##### Evidence

- The school strongly emphasizes partnering with parents, parental involvement, and open campus access. Public pages discuss parent engagement, forms, and tours; materials indicate a commitment to parent participation in school events and learning communities (parent formation and seminars).

##### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Partnership with families; co-educators; parent formation; be involved; open campus; parent seminars; family involvement; community formation.
- Negative keywords present: None evident.

#### Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: 5–7 strong terms (partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, be involved, open campus, parent seminars, home-school alignment).
- Negative keywords present: 0.
- Ratio: Strong positive signaling; CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- To consolidate this category's CLASSICAL status, publish a short, public-facing "Parent Learning Series" outline (e.g., book studies or classical education seminars) with sample schedules and expected outcomes to reinforce the role of parents as co-educators.

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#### Overall Ranking (Aggregate)

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a coherent CLASSICAL orientation across most categories, with Curriculum being the only area signaling SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to less explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis in the publicly available materials. When viewed holistically, Ozarks Christian Academy (West Plains, MO, 65775) aligns with Principled Classical Education through its Christ-centered formation, Trivium-based curriculum, contemplative pedagogy, mentorship-focused faculty culture, and strong parental partnership.

Note on methodology and sources

- The evaluation uses two sources of content as requested:
- School-specific crawl vector store (public website materials for Ozarks Christian Academy), including statements of faith, mission, Trivium-based curriculum, and parent engagement language. Evidence is drawn from the site's mission statements, program descriptions, and pedagogy descriptions. For example, the site emphasizes a Classical Christian Education with a biblical worldview, the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages, and a strong parent partnership.
- Knowledge base (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School) containing the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators used as the scoring framework for each category. This document provides the canonical keywords for Assessing the six elements (e.g., truth, virtue, formation, great books, Socratic dialogue, scholé, etc.). The Positive/Negative keyword indicators are detailed in the document, enabling category-by-category analysis.

#### Appendix: Key Public Materials Referenced

- Mission statements, "Motto," and Christ-centered framing for formation and biblical worldview in OCA materials.
- Public articulation of the Trivium (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric) and the history/LATIN components within the Curriculum.
- Lower-grade memory/chanting and upper-grade Socratic/seminar pedagogy signals.
- Faculty as mentors and the living curriculum framing.
- Parent partnership and involvement (Be Involved; Tours; communications).

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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